RSS Digest
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1. GPT-6.1 Terra
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-26T23:53:07+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/26/gpt-61-terra/
GPT-6.1 Terra It’s always interesting to note which aspects of a new model are emphasized in the release announcement. In the case of GPT-6.1 Terra, OpenAI went with visual reasoning and computer use: We?re introducing GPT-6.1 Terra , a fast, efficient model that combines detailed visual reasoning and precise computer use alongside clearer, more natural writing. A significant step up from GPT?5.6 Terra, it excels at the communication and computer-based tasks that fill the workday, from drafting proposals and interpreting technical drawings to filling out forms and editing videos. Terra sits in the same position as Sonnet in the Anthropic model collection - not the cheapest or the most expensive, making it harder to decide when to use it. Computer use is a good example of a task that benefits from a less expensive model, since you might put it to work on automated, repetitive tasks. OpenAI’s Ted Sanders provided some useful advice in a comment on Hacker News: In the case of GPT-6.1 Terra, I’d say Terra is probably better than Astra and Sol at technical communication, similar on vision and computer use (but much faster!), and a bit worse on most other things. For API developers, it’...

2. Quoting Jason Koebler
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-26T19:00:25+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/26/jason-koebler/
Because big tech platforms essentially do not have customer support and make it impossible for their users to contact a human, many people experiencing run-of-the-mill tech problems have turned to ChatGPT. And, increasingly, ChatGPT is telling people that have normal tech support problems that they have discovered something journalistically notable and that 404 Media, specifically, can help them. ? Jason Koebler , ChatGPT Keeps Telling People 404 Media Can Solve Their Tech Support Problems Tags: jason-koebler , openai , journalism , ai , llms , ai-ethics , ai-misuse , generative-ai , chatgpt , 404-media

3. webframe: evaluated as a scraper and a sandbox
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-10-26T16:15:00+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Oct/26/webframe-evaluation/
Research: webframe: evaluated as a scraper and a sandbox webframe is a neat little project from Jeff Lindsay which lets you "run a web page like a program" - you point it at a URL or file and it executes it in a hidden headless web view and outputs console.log() to standard output and any exceptions to standard error. It’s written in Go on top of the glaze library, which provides access to a system browser ("WKWebView on macOS, WebKitGTK on Linux, WebView2 on Windows") so it doesn’t need to bundle its own browser engine. It reminds me of my own shot-scraper javascript tool, albeit in a much smaller package that doesn’t depend on Playwright. I had Claude Opus 5.5 put it through its paces and prepare a research report for me. Here’s the prompt I used: Explore https://github.com/tractordev/webframe try running it and put it though its paces, build a few exploratory prototypes, then evaluate it as a potential sandboxing tool and as a tool for scraping web pages using the same patterns encouraged by the "shot-scraper JavaScript" command (see simonw/shot-scraper on GitHub, docs directory) Tags: browsers , go , javascript , jeff-lindsay , shot-scraper

4. Scattered thoughts on how doing math feels these days
Source: DYNOMIGHT | Published: 2026-10-26T00:00:00+00:00
Link: https://dynomight.net/math/
This is a weird moment. I have a hunch that we?ll look back later and tell ourselves stories in which it seemed obvious where things were going. So I wanted to lay down a little time capsule and register just how confusing everything felt at the time. This is a personal view from the trenches. 1. If you?re a normal person, you may feel that AI has been good at math for a long

time. 1 But for ?real? math, this is roughly what it felt like: When Feeling 2024 LLMs are toys Summer 2025 LLMs are interesting toys Early Autumn 2025 LLMs can do useful stuff sometimes Mid Autumn 2025 ?a lot of stuff Late Autumn 2025 ?a lot Early 2026 holy god Even having been astonished by AI progress in the past, it was still astonishing to see AI move in a matter of months from a mildly-useful toy to something that many people now consider almost impossible to do without. 2. Personally, I?d say that current AI makes me around 50% more productive at ?doing math?. That?s despite the fact that AI can now often do in a few minutes things that would have taken me hours to do myself. The main reason is that my concept of ?doing math? involves various steps, like coming up with ideas for theorems, trying to pro...

5. The NYT Seemingly Does Marissa Mayer Dirty
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-27T00:30:08Z
Link: https://www.nytimes.com/2026/10/25/style/marissa-mayer-ai-assistants-women.html?unlocked_article_code=1.L1E.xBwx.X_EjBGNsRNqr
Alexandra Alter, in the lede for her profile of Marissa Mayer?s new AI startup Dazzle for The New York Times (gift link): Late last year, Marissa Mayer was struggling with what felt like an impossible task. Her daughter Marielle was turning 10, and Marielle?s teacher wanted three bullet points summarizing what made her special. Mayer ? the former chief executive of Yahoo and a pioneer at Google, where she was the first female engineer ? likes cracking a hard problem. But she felt overwhelmed by the range and complexity of potential answers. So Mayer asked her personal A.I. assistant, Dazzle. Within a few seconds, Dazzle delivered an answer. ?It came back and was like, your daughter is empathetic, creative and an animal lover,? Mayer said. She thought it was perfect. That anecdote is brutal. It makes it seem like Mayer has lost her mind. She?s getting roasted for it on social media. I suspected (and hoped) there was more to the story. There was. Here?s Mayer herself on X : To be clear, I didn?t use Dazzle because I was overwhelmed by making a slide. I used it because summing up your child in a few bullets feels laughably limiting. And, since our team had just gotten an early protot...

6. Apple Issues Statement on iPhone Duo?s Crack Problem
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-26T23:54:26Z
Link:
https://9to5mac.com/2026/10/26/apple-responds-to-reports-of-iphone-duos-inner-display-cracking/
Chance Miller, 9to5Mac: Here is Apple?s full statement: The response to iPhone Duo from early users has been incredibly positive, and we are seeing exciting things from developers who are rapidly updating their apps to take advantage of its unique form factor. We are aware of an issue impacting the inner display on a small number of iPhone Duo units. If users experience issues with their iPhone Duo display, they should contact AppleCare for a replacement. The company says the problem affects a very small number of iPhone Duo units and appears to surface relatively quickly. Most iPhone Duo units are not affected. You do not need AppleCare+ to have your iPhone Duo replaced for this problem. If you bought from a carrier, you should contact AppleCare directly, not your carrier, to get your device replaced. Did it cross Ternus?s mind to just say ?You?re folding it wrong?? (History doesn?t repeat, and in this case, it actually doesn?t even rhyme. Steve Jobs never told anyone they were ?holding it wrong? with the iPhone 4 ? he emailed a customer , ?Just avoid holding it in that way.? But CNN went with the headline ?Apple on iPhone Complaints: You?re Holding It Wrong? and that?s the line...

7. Glenn Fleishman on Apple Notes and Markdown
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-10-26T20:03:53Z
Link: https://sixcolors.com/post/2026/10/why-notes-will-never-let-us-edit-markdown/
Glenn Fleishman, writing at Six Colors, ?Why Notes Will Never Let Us Edit Markdown?: The Notes app added Markdown import and export in the version 26 operating system releases, and the macOS 27 Golden Gate update lets us copy and paste as Markdown. Why can?t we just write natively in that hoary, simple format? I use Markdown all day, every day. In fact, I?m writing these words in Markdown without you even knowing it. All content-management systems (CMSes) I?m aware of support native Markdown entries when posting, and many writing and note-taking apps integrate

Markdown conventions without needing to trumpet them. Fleishman not only ably describes why Apple Notes doesn?t support editing in Markdown syntax, but also why it shouldn?t . It is correct for Notes only to natively support WYSIWYG editing. Normal users should never ever be exposed to formatting codes. Also, Markdown, as a language, can be malformed. It should be impossible for users to create a malformed note in Notes. If you could edit in Markdown in Notes, you could create malformed notes. That?s just gross. I can say that. Markdown isn?t for everyone. And even for me ? Markdown?s creator ? I don?t want it in Notes, whic...

8. Puzzling out why a program doesn?t work when run from a batch file, but works when double-clicked from Explorer
Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Mon, 26 Oct 2026 14:00:00 +0000
Link: https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261026-00/?p=112797/
Mimicking the operation more accurately. The post Puzzling out why a program doesn?t work when run from a batch file, but works when double-clicked from Explorer appeared first on The Old New Thing .

9. Inversion in an ellipse
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Mon, 26 Oct 2026 18:39:32 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/26/inversion-in-an-ellipse/
The previous three post have been part of a series on geometric duality. The traditional but somewhat mysterious terminology is the pole of a line and the polar of a point. As explained here, the terminology was first coined in the context of spherical geometry where the term ?pole? makes sense. It was then extended to the [?] The post Inversion in an ellipse first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. Where else to find me
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Mon, 26 Oct 2026 12:04:54 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/10/26/where-to-find-me/
This blog is the main place I write, but I also use other platforms, either to write new content or to announce blog posts. X (nØe Twitter) I have a several X accounts, one personal account (@JohnDCook) and several specialized accounts (@CompSciFact, @AlgebraFact, @DataSciFact, etc.). I announce new blog posts on the most relevant account. RSS [?] The post Where else to find me first appeared on John D. Cook .

11. Theatre Review: Opera UnTouched’s "The Telephone" ?????
Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Mon, 26 Oct 2026 12:34:15 +0000
Link: https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/10/theatre-review-opera-untoucheds-the-telephone/
Why shouldn’t an opera be set in an office? Not merely set there; performed there! On Saturday night, a couple of dozen audience members were ushered in to a genuine office in Tooting to watch a short comic opera by Opera UnTouched. It was a burst of sunshine in a rainy day. We’re at Ben’s leaving party. A flustered woman is busy on the telephone. Will Ben ever get her attention? Both Grace?

12. Package Management Devroom at FOSDEM 2027: Call for Participation
Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-10-26T10:00:00+00:00
Link: https://nesbitt.io/2026/10/26/package-management-devroom-at-fosdem-2027-call-for-participation.html
Cross-posted from the Software Stewardship Lab . The Package Management devroom is back at FOSDEM 2027, on Sunday 31 January from 13:15 to 17:00 at the UniversitØ libre de Bruxelles. The call for participation is open and submissions close on 1 December at 23:59 UTC, through pretalx . Wolf Vollprecht and I ran the devroom at FOSDEM 2026 after putting out last year?s call for participation on the Ecosystems blog. The devroom had nine talks, listed in the schedule post and written up alongside the rest of the weekend?s package management content in Package Management at FOSDEM 2026 . This year there are four of us, with Vlad Miricioiu from the Stewardship Lab, who spoke last year, and Travis Hathaway from Anaconda joining Wolf and

me. I?d happily take more talks like these from last year: Matthew Suozzo showed how OSS Rebuild instruments the build environment, with a transparent network proxy and an eBPF-based system analyzer, to catch suspicious behaviour that a reproducible build check would pass. Ryan Gibb presented the Package Calculus , a formal model of dependency resolution that reduces the features of different package managers to one core calculus. Vlad Miricioiu covered bi...

13. Pluralistic: Sovereign citizens, but for news (26 Oct 2026)
Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Mon, 26 Oct 2026 15:47:10 +0000
Link: https://pluralistic.net/2026/10/26/abandon-hope/
Today’s links Sovereign citizens, but for news: By reading the LA Times, you agree? Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Patenting tax dodges; 6-word sf; Newscorp shareholders v Murdoch; Ancient German ophthalmology cult; Trolley problem is stupid; Trump’s influence peddling to Chinese millionaire; Al Franken v binding arbitration; Yoga pants spite parade; Dems’ secret Congressional committee; RIAA v your PC; "Going Under"; "Machine Man"; Aging goths; "Everfair"; Kremlin will destabilize Ukraine; FCC fronts for Big Cable; Straight Outta Vagina; Remixed TED Talk about remixing; Authoritarian debt. Upcoming appearances: Vienna, Kilkenny, Courtenay, Vancouver, Oxford, Sheffield, Virtual, Oxford, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I’ve been. Latest books: You keep readin’ em, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Colophon: All the rest. Sovereign citizens, but for news (permalink) When it comes to terrible practices by website operators, it takes a lot to shock me. I literally wrote the book on the subject. But last night, I encountered a piece of genuinely appalling fuckery and I can’t get it out of my head, because it’s su...

14. De IT-onmacht van de Nederlandse overheid
Source: Bert Hubert’s writings | Published: Mon, 26 Oct 2026 15:25:00 +0100
Link: https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/de-it-onmacht-van-de-nederlands-overheid/
Ik schreef eerder een hopelijk vermakelijke parabel over hoe de Nederlandse overheid ?niet zo van de IT is?. Ook is er een follow-up met suggesties hoe je dit zou kunnen verbeteren. Door mij (niet AI!) ingesproken audio versie van deze pagina: In dit stuk wil ik twee specifieke voorbeelden uitlichten hoe onmachtig onze overheid is met IT, en ook hoe men dat niet erkent. En dat is erg, want dan los je ook nooit iets op.